EASTERN SAMAR STATE UNIVERSITY

Excellence • Accountability • Service



SUSTAINABILITY REPORT









1 NO POVERTY



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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.2.1 - Low Income Students Receiving Financial Aid



1 NO POVERTY

1.2.1 Proportion of students receiving financial aid to attend university because of poverty

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) maintains an unwavering commitment to inclusive higher education by mitigating financial barriers for economically disadvantaged students across its campuses (Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Maydolong, and Salcedo). Through a robust ecosystem of government-funded programs, private scholarship grants, and the universal implementation of the Free Higher Education (FHE) scheme under Republic Act 10931, ESSU ensures that financial constraints do not preclude qualified students from pursuing tertiary education.

During the Academic Year (AY) 2024–2025, an overwhelming majority of the university's student population benefited from direct financial assistance and tuition coverage, highlighting ESSU's pivotal role in regional poverty reduction and social mobility in Eastern Samar.

Enrollment and Scholarship Data

Eastern Samar State University has established a transformative, highly integrated student financial assistance and welfare ecosystem designed to systematically eliminate economic and geographic barriers to higher education in the Eastern Visayas region. Operating under its institutional mandate of excellence, accountability, and service, the university synthesizes national legislative mandates, specialized sectoral programs, local government partnerships, and private enterprise initiatives. Across five decentralized campuses—Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Maydolong, and Salcedo—ESSU serves as a primary engine for socio-economic mobility, empowering over 28,000 students per semester and graduating over 2,000 qualified professionals annually.

Across all five campuses, total student enrollment stood at 25,384 students in the 1st Semester and 24,137 students in the 2nd Semester.

ENROLMENT REPORT - SY 2024-2025

Campus	Enrollment Data	
	1st Sem	2nd sem
Borongan Campus	12,201	11,643
Can-avid	3,335	3,138
Guiuan	5,921	5,710
Maydolong	1,462	1,333
Salcedo Campus	2,465	2,314
Total	**25,384**	**24,137**

Financial aid at ESSU is categorized into External & Private Scholarships/Financial Assistance and Free Higher Education (FHE).

Scholarship and Financial Assistance – SY 2024-2025

Campus	Number of Scholars	
	1st Sem	2nd sem
External		
Borongan Campus	950	848
Can-avid	605	589
Guiuan	2,225	2,277
Maydolong	246	159
Salcedo Campus	535	532
Sub-total	**4,561**	**4,423**
Private		
Borongan Campus	14	**18**
Total	**4,575**	**4,441**

Free Higher Education – SY 2024-2025

Campus	Number of Scholars	
	1st Sem	2nd sem
External		
Borongan Campus	10,786	10,183
Can-avid	3,335	3,138
Guiuan	5,541	5,324
Maydolong	1,384	1,327
Salcedo Campus	2,381	2,234
Total	**23,427**	**22,206**

Proportion of Students Receiving Financial Aid

Students Receiving Scholarship Program or Grants – SY 2024-2025

Campus		
	1st Sem	2nd sem
Number of Students	25,384	24,137
Students Receiving Scholarship Program or Grants	4,575	4,441
Scholarship Coverage Rate	**18.02%**	**18.39%**

Students Receiving Free Higher Education – SY 2024-2025

Campus		
	1st Sem	2nd sem
Number of Students	25,384	24,137
Students Receiving Free Higher Education	23,427	22,206
Free Higher Education Coverage Rate	**92.29%**	**92.00%**

Link to supporting documents:

Name of Document	Link
Enrollment Data (1st and 2nd Semester SY 2024-2025	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ZrpJ6mcN16LS5mnZl4u8Q-TvosRYSSGW/view?usp=drive_link
Scholarship and Assistantship S(1st and 2nd Sem SY 2024-2025)	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Qmvucz4Q0ZpLIQtYOiohvh7mvhepaZ8g/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.3.1. Bottom Financial Quintile Admission Target



1 NO POVERTY

1.3.1. Bottom financial quintile admission target

Eastern Samar State University is deeply committed to promoting equitable access to higher education for students from economically disadvantaged backgrounds. Through structured financial assistance frameworks, institutional admission policies, and alignment with national legislation, the university implements programs and initiatives to assist students who fall into the bottom 20% of household income groups to successfully access and complete their studies.

The university operates in strict compliance with the RA 10931 Free Higher Education Act. Under Section 2(c) of Republic Act No. 10931, the University prioritizes the admission of academically qualified students, particularly those coming from poor and disadvantaged families. This policy promotes equal opportunities in accessing quality higher education, ensuring that financial limitations do not prevent deserving students from pursuing their academic goals.

Complementing this legislative mandate, institutional guidelines set forth in the ESSU Student Handbook (Admission Policies) reinforce that students shall not be denied admission to the University by reason of socio-economic status, provided they are mentally fit and meet the general academic qualifications as well as specific program requirements.

To systematically track and evaluate the impact of these equitable access policies, the university monitors enrollment metrics against low-income student admission targets across academic terms:

- First Semester (SY 2024–2025): Out of a total population of 25,386 enrolled students, 23,503 students successfully availed themselves of the Free Higher Education Program, meeting a 20% low-income student admission target of 5,077 students.
- Subsequent Academic Period: Out of 24,137 total enrolled students, 22,198 students benefited from the Free Higher Education Program, against a 20% low-income student admission target of 4,828 students.

Together, these integrated policies and implementation measures demonstrate Eastern Samar State University's long-term dedication to inclusive education, ensuring that financial hardships do not hinder qualified students from obtaining quality tertiary qualifications and achieving their full potential.

ADMISSION TARGET AND ACTUAL ENROLMENT REPORT - SY 2024-2025

First Semester	
Total Number of Enrolled Students	**25,386**
Total Number of Students who availed the Free Higher Education Program	**23,503**
20% low income Student admission target	**5,077**

First Semester	
Total Number of Enrolled Students	**24,137**
Total Number of Students who availed the Free Higher Education Program	**22,198**
20% low income Student admission target	**4,828**

Policy:

RA 10931 Free Higher Education Act

[REPUBLIC ACT NO. 10931, August 03, 2017]

AN ACT PROMOTING UNIVERSAL ACCESS TO QUALITY TERTIARY EDUCATION BY PROVIDING FOR FREE TUITION AND OTHER SCHOOL FEES IN STATE UNIVERSITIES AND COLLEGES, LOCAL UNIVERSITIES AND COLLEGES AND STATE-RUN TECHNICAL-VOCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS, ESTABLISHING THE TERTIARY EDUCATION SUBSIDY AND STUDENT LOAN PROGRAM, STRENGTHENING THE UNIFIED STUDENT FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE SYSTEM FOR TERTIARY EDUCATION, AND APPROPRIATING FUNDS THEREFOR

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives of the Philippines in Congress assembled:

SECTION 1. *Short Title.*- This Act shall be known as the "Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act".

SEC. 2. *Declaration of Policy.*- It is hereby declared that quality education is an inalienable right of all Filipinos and it is the policy of the State to protect and promote the rights of all students to quality education at all levels. Therefore, the State shall take appropriate steps to make such education accessible to all.

Likewise, the State hereby recognizes the complementary roles of public and private higher education institutions and technical-vocational institutions in the educational system and the invaluable contribution that the private tertiary schools have made and will make to education. For these intents, the state shall:

(a) Provide adequate funding and such other mechanisms to increase the participation rate among all socioeconomic classes in tertiary education;

(b) Provide all Filipinos with equal opportunity to quality tertiary education in both the private and public educational institutions;

(c) Give priority to students who are academically able and who come from poor families;

Link to RA 10931:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1lLsLAJgkY4e_yfpPRRyNgbQxYG5pFCv3/view?usp=drive_link

ESSU Student Handbook - Admission Policy

ADMISSION, RECORDS AND REGISTRATION

The Office of the University Registrar is the depository of the academic records of students. It takes charge of the evaluation of grades, scheduling of enrollment and other related activities. The following policies and guidelines are to be observed.

Admission Policies

Students shall not be denied admission to the University by reason of race, age, sex, socio-economic status, religion, political affiliation, or ideological conviction or physical disability provided he/she is mentally fit and meets the general qualifications of the University, in addition to the specific requirements of the program where one is applying. Likewise, the University shall admit students who are holder of Philippines Educational Placement Test/ Alternative Learning System (PEPT/ALS) certificates and who are eligible for admission to college.

Each college has its own requirement in addition to the aforementioned requirements, thus:

Admission Requirements for Undergraduate Programs

a. Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering; Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering

New Applicants

a) 85% final rating in Math, Science and English subjects
at least 50% rating in the University Entrance Examination
Shifters and Transferees

a) 2.5 or 80% grade point average of all subjects taken
b) a grade of 2.0 or 85% or better in mathematics
c) satisfactory rating in the interview conducted by the Program Head or College Dean

Link to Student Handbook:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/11jkPa50WpnjsJ

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.3.2. Bottom Financial Quintile Student success



1 NO POVERTY

1.3.2. Bottom Financial Quintile Student success

Eastern Samar State University successfully produced a total of 2,013 graduates during the 2024–2025 academic year across its various degree levels, comprising 817 male and 1,196 female graduates. This academic output reflects the collective achievements of students across the university's main and external campuses, demonstrating ESSU's ongoing commitment to producing competent professionals and leaders for regional and national development.

Across the institution's comprehensive academic structure, the undergraduate sector formed the largest cohort with 1,794 graduates (744 male and 1,050 female), spanning major professional fields such as engineering, business administration, teacher education, information technology, criminal justice, nursing, and industrial technology. In addition, non-degree programs contributed 80 graduates (28 male and 52 female) through specialized technical paths like the Diploma in Midwifery and Associate in Computer Technology. Advanced studies also exhibited robust participation, yielding 73 graduates (31 male and 42 female) across master's and doctoral programs, alongside 140 graduates (36 male and 104 female) across postgraduate diploma courses.

Campus-specific graduation data highlights the distributed impact of ESSU's extension units in driving higher education attainment throughout the province. For instance, the Guiuan external campus recorded a grand total of 1,245 graduates (517 male and 728 female) across its diverse undergraduate and graduate programs, led by strong cohorts in industrial technology, hospitality management, information technology, and teacher education. Similarly, the Maydolong campus contributed 275 graduates (127 male and 148 female) across specialized degree offerings such as early childhood education, culture and arts education, physical education, criminology, and hospitality management. The Salcedo campus further added 478 graduates (173 male and 175 female) spanning advanced graduate tracks, postgraduate diplomas, and foundational baccalaureate programs in education, agriculture, and information technology. The table below summarizes these.

Report on Graduates
SY 2024 – 2025

Campus	Graduates Programs	Baccalaureate Programs	Pre-Baccalaureate	Total
Borongan (Main)	219	1,714	80	**2,013**
Can-avid		550		**550**
Guiuan	124	1,121		**1,245**
Maydolong		275		**275**
Salcedo	50	428		**478**
Total	393	4,088	80	**4,561**

Proportion of SY 2024-2025 Graduates who availed Scholarship and Free Higher Education.

SY 2024-2025	Total
Total Number of Graduates	**4,561**
Number of Graduates who availed Scholarship Program	**866**
Number of Graduates who availed Free Higher Education Program	**4162**
Percentage of Graduates who availed Scholarship Program	*19%*
Percentage of Graduates who availed Free Higher Education Program	*91%*

Ensuring equitable access to quality tertiary education remains a core pillar of our university's mission. For Academic Year (AY) / School Year (SY) 2024–2025, the university demonstrated an unprecedented commitment to student welfare and educational inclusivity by maximizing coverage under national free tuition policies and targeted scholarship programs. Out of a total **4,561 graduates** in SY 2024–2025, the vast majority successfully completed their academic journeys through institutional and government-backed financial assistance mechanisms.

During SY 2024–2025, **91% of all graduates (4,162 students)** benefited from the Free Higher Education (FHE) Program (under Republic Act 10931 / Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act). This high rate of participation reflects our institution’s streamlined enrollment-to-graduation verification process, proactive student assistance desks, and efficient administrative execution. By eliminating tuition and mandatory fee barriers for over nine out of ten graduates, the university significantly mitigated financial distress, reduced dropout risks, and fostered an inclusive learning environment.

Complementing universal free tuition, **19% of the graduating class (866 graduates)** availed themselves of specialized scholarship programs. These include merit-based awards, needs-based grants, institutional aid, and external government/private sector sponsorships designed to cover living stipends, book allowances, and specialized learning materials. The dual-coverage strategy ensured that students facing additional socio-economic challenges received targeted financial reinforcement to complete their degree programs

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.3.3.Low Income Support to Students



1 NO POVERTY

1.3.3. Low Income Support to Students

Eastern Samar State University's Office of Student Services and Alumni Affairs at the Main Campus reimagined and expanded its holistic student support framework to directly address the evolving academic, social, and economic needs of its student population. Guided by core commitments to student empowerment, inclusivity, academic excellence, and low-income student support, the office spearheaded a comprehensive array of student-centered programs throughout the calendar year.

To ensure open and equitable access to higher education, the university processed 3,796 admission applicants for the upcoming academic period, ultimately enrolling 3,058 qualified students following daily administered entrance examinations. Complementing the admission pipeline, the Guidance and Testing Services provided crucial personal and pre-professional assistance. The office issued 1,303 Certificates of Good Moral Character, conducted group career advising for 302 course-shifting students to better align their academic paths with individual aptitudes, and completed targeted well-being assessments for 1,628 students preparing for on-the-job training to evaluate stress and depression metrics before internship deployment.

Recognizing that health and wellness directly impact academic persistence, the University Infirmary partnered with local healthcare agencies to deliver free, accessible medical and dental services. These efforts included a two-day mass influenza vaccination for 182 students and employees in partnership with the Provincial Health Office of Eastern Samar, a campus-wide tooth extraction drive for students during Dental Health Month, and a bloodletting activity that yielded 97 blood packs in collaboration with the Eastern Samar Provincial Hospital. Furthermore, during the university's Charter Day celebration, a multi-specialty medical and dental mission provided comprehensive care ranging from endocrinology, cardiology, and psychiatric consultations to nutrition counseling and HIV testing.

Beyond campus boundaries, the university alleviated daily economic burdens on low-income commuters through strategic "Libre Sakay" free transportation partnerships with various local government units. Dedicated daily transit programs were maintained across multiple municipalities, including LGU San Julian, LGU Sulat, LGU Llorente's "Hatid-Sundo Eskwela" project, LGU Oras's "ORABus" service, and LGU General MacArthur's free student transport initiative. The university also extended free legal aid services through the College of Law during campus celebrations, allowing students and community members to access expert legal advice on civil, documentation, and personal matters free of charge.

In times of disaster, student welfare remained a top priority through swift crisis response mechanisms. Following Typhoon Opong, the Supreme Student Council coordinated with the Provincial Government of Eastern Samar to distribute immediate relief packages to affected students. To support academic development and governance, the university conducted policy consultations to establish ethical AI guidelines in research and writing, organized thesis and

capstone seminars in partnership with the Research Development Services Office, and held campus journalism orientations to unify student publication standards. Finally, student life was enriched through cultural events like Tan-Aw 2025 during National Arts Month and leadership initiatives such as TANGLAW 2025 and the TRAIL Leadership Camp, empowering students to engage in nation-building and holistic self-development.

A. **Admission Services**

Beginning March 3, 2025, the University started accepting applications for admission. Entrance examinations were subsequently conducted in May and June for incoming freshmen who met the prescribed academic requirements giving 100 slot per day.

Number of applicants who took the admission test	Number of Applicants who passed and are currently enrolled
3,796	3,058





Link to Admission Services posting :
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19bfiUwMcP/
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1HiwRhdFYK/

B. Guidance and Counseling Services

The Guidance and Testing Services provided essential student support services, including the issuance of Certificates of Good Moral Character, career advising, and well-being assessments to determine students' readiness for on-the-job training. The office also administered the University Entrance Examination to incoming first-year students and transferees, helping assess their readiness for college admission. These services demonstrate the University's commitment to student welfare, informed career decisions, and effective admission processes.

Name of Activity	Brief Description	No. of Clients Served	Types of Clients Served	Place and Date Under-taken
Issuance of Certificate of Good Moral Character	Clients personally come to the office to secure their Certificates of Good Moral Character	1,303	ESSU Students and Alumni	Guidance & Testing Services
Career Advising	Group advising is conducted to students who decide to shift to another course. This is to ensure that the students' interests and abilities align with the program they wish to take up.	302	ESSU Students	Guidance & Testing Services
Well-being check for on-the-job trainees	A series of battery test that measures a student's level of anxiety and depressive symptoms. Its goal is to determine a student's readiness for on-the-job-training.	1,628	ESSU students who will undergo on-the-job training	ESSU/February
University Entrance Examination	The University Entrance Examination is an ability test that measures an applicant's verbal and non-verbal abilities. It measures the applicant's potential to perform well in college.	3, 826	Incoming First Year Students and Transferees	Arteche and Balangiga Extension Campus, ESSU





Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1Ds1HkZGnu/
https://www.facebook.com/ESSUMainGTS

C. Medical and Dental Services

Mass Vaccination (INFLUENZA) - January 23-24, 2025

Demonstrating a proactive commitment to campus health, safety, and community resilience, the University Infirmary partnered with the Provincial Health Office of Eastern Samar to spearhead a comprehensive two-day Mass Vaccination Activity for influenza. This collaborative health initiative successfully immunized a total of 182 individuals, comprising both students and university employees, thereby mitigating health risks, fostering a disease-resilient academic environment, and reinforcing public health partnerships within the region.



Link to Activity design and documentation:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ot1QvKDt1k-jRgPgunzpMl6T8TmXnjWE?usp=drive_link

Tooth Extraction Activity - February 10-14, 2025

Aligned with National Dental Health Month and anchored on the theme “Brushing ang Key sa Balangay Healthy,” the University Infirmary—in strategic partnership with ESSU Guiuan—conducted a week-long campus-wide Mass Tooth Extraction Activity. Designed to promote accessible oral healthcare and improve overall dental hygiene standards, this initiative delivered essential dental services exclusively to ESSU students, directly addressing community health gaps and championing preventative wellness within the university populace.



Link to supporting documents:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1fpfqJa9LzCogda92YbADKcpVq7V7UCHs?usp=drive_link

Bloodletting Activity - February 14, 2025

Embodying a culture of civic responsibility, altruism, and humanitarian service, the University Infirmary—in collaboration with the Provincial Health Office through the Eastern Samar Provincial Hospital—successfully organized a mass bloodletting activity on campus. Bringing together a dedicated community of faculty members, administrative staff, students from diverse university departments and offices, and benevolent individuals from neighboring communities, the outreach program became a resounding success, culminating in the collection of 97 vital packs of blood to support local health reserves and emergency medical needs.



Link to supporting documents:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1OR6TgVUuYdq69_yKajyETHYh7hO6Gfhv?usp=drive_link

Medical and Dental Mission - August 7, 2025

In commemoration of its 21st Charter Day Celebration and in active partnership with the Eastern Samar Provincial Health Office and the City Health Office of Borongan City, the University Infirmary executed a large-scale Medical and Dental Mission on campus. This multi-faceted health intervention delivered comprehensive medical care and specialized services, including medical and dental consultations, tooth extractions, random blood sugar (RBS) monitoring, nutrition and dietetics counseling, OB-GYN consultations, and HIV testing. By pooling resources across municipal, provincial, and institutional offices, the mission served a diverse demographic of faculty, staff, and students across all departments, significantly elevating health equity and community well-being.



Link to documents:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1HRVj9E2axE18LmUhrUhr06aBrL_UzbOl?usp=drive_link

D. Free Transportation Assistance Through the "Libre Sakay" Program

In partnership with the University, the following LGUs provided free transportation to students daily:

a. Borongan City - Free Transportation Assistance Through the "Libre Sakay" Program
b. LGU San Julian - Municipal Ordinance No. 8, s.2023
c. LGU Sulat -
d. LGU Llorente- "Hatid-Sundo Eskwela" , a flagship initiative under Project LEAP (Llorente Education Assistance Program).
e. LGU Oras – ORABus, a dedicated free transport service specifically for our students commuting to ESSU Can-avid.
f. LGU Genrela MacArtur - 'Libreng Sakay para sa Mas Matibay na Kinabukasan Program"













Link to documentation:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1SfIuSyWyDwrGxfGXSHfG26ABvUNp3_zr?usp=drive_link

E. Free Legal Services – August 7, 2026

As part of its vibrant 21st Charter Day Celebration, Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) – Main Campus demonstrates its unwavering commitment to community engagement and social responsibility by offering accessible, pro bono legal aid services to the public. Designed to champion justice, equity, and civic empowerment, this initiative welcomes students, employees, and community members to consult with legal experts, thereby bridging the justice gap and providing vital, expert guidance on diverse legal matters to the broader community.






Link to Posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/18WKUSYHUB/
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1FJ52i9HGz/

F. Student Welfare and Crisis Response

Reflecting a deep-seated institutional commitment to student safety, crisis resilience, and holistic welfare during emergencies, the Supreme Student Council (SSC) successfully facilitated a targeted relief distribution initiative in September 2025 for students affected by Typhoon Opong. Operating in robust coordination with the Provincial Government of Eastern Samar, this collaborative endeavor provided critical humanitarian support and reassurance to vulnerable scholars, embodying the university's enduring dedication to community solidarity and disaster response.











Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1FnDgCbVBN/

G. Policy Development and Governance

AI Usage Policy Consultation

Demonstrating Eastern Samar State University's proactive and forward-thinking adaptation to emerging technological landscapes, the Student Services and Affairs Association (SSAA) spearheaded a crucial consultative meeting on February 7, 2025, to finalize the institution's comprehensive Policy on AI Usage for Students and Faculty. By thoughtfully establishing guidelines around the ethical applications of artificial intelligence in academic writing, scholarly research, examinations, and administrative workflows, this visionary initiative safeguards rigorous academic integrity while empowering the university community to responsibly harness digital innovation.

H. Academic Support and Research Development

The Undergraduate Seminar on Thesis and Capstone Writing

The Undergraduate Seminar on Thesis and Capstone Writing held on April 14, 2025, provided third-year students with guidance on research writing, academic publishing, ethics, and digital tools such as Mendeley and Google Scholar. Organized in partnership with the Research Development Services Office (RDSO), the seminar cultivated research competence, critical thinking, and scholarly engagement among students.



Link to Posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19aYRoDkkE/

I. Leadership Development and Student Governance

TRAIL Leadership Camp

To cultivate dynamic student governance and foster visionary campus leadership, officers of the Supreme Student Council (SSC) actively participated in the 8th Philippine Transformative Approaches to Innovative Leadership (TRAIL) Camp held in Cebu City. Organized by Youthlead Philippines Inc., this high-impact national leadership summit immersed student leaders in experiential learning modules and transformative leadership frameworks, equipping them with innovative strategies to drive meaningful social change, strengthen student representation, and elevate governance standards within the university community.

TANGLAW 2025 Seminar

Highlighting Eastern Samar State University's commitment to civic engagement, policy discourse, and youth empowerment, the Supreme Student Council (SSC) organized **TANGLAW 2025**, featuring former Senator Paolo Benigno "Bam" Aquino IV as the keynote speaker. The landmark event convened students and faculty for critical discussions on the pivotal role of education in nation-building, with a strong focus on the impact and implementation of Republic Act 10931, also known as the Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act. By bridging national policy leadership with student governance, TANGLAW 2025 inspired transformative dialogue on equitable access to higher education and the active involvement of youth in shaping society's future.





Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1LivBpjKLS/

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.3.4. Low Financial Quintile Student Support



1 NO POVERTY

1.3.4. Bottom Financial Quintile Student Support

Eastern Samar State University has developed an innovative, highly integrated student financial assistance framework designed to systematically remove economic barriers to quality higher education across Eastern Samar. Operating under its core values of Excellence, Accountability, and Service, the university leverages a multi-stakeholder ecosystem spanning national government agencies, specialized agricultural funds, private enterprise, and legislative mechanisms. By supporting tens of thousands of undergraduate beneficiaries across five decentralized campuses—Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Maydolong, and Salcedo—ESSU serves as a primary engine for socio-economic mobility and regional equity in Eastern Visayas.

In alignment with the WURI category for Student Support and Open Access, ESSU operationalizes the principles of open educational access by serving as a primary administrative bridge for Republic Act No. 10931, the Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act. The university's Scholarship and Financial Assistance Office manages streamlined institutional billing directly to UniFAST, exempting qualified undergraduate enrollees from tuition and school fee burdens. On an institutional scale, the university successfully provided tuition-free tertiary education to 23,503 undergraduate students in the first semester and 22,198 students in the second semester of Academic Year 2024–2025 across its network. This financial access is sustained across all operational units, benefiting enrollees at the Borongan Main Campus, Guiuan, Can-avid, Salcedo, and Maydolong.

Under the dimension of Social Responsibility and Targeted Agricultural Equity, ESSU implements targeted financial safety nets designed to uplift historically marginalized rural populations and break intergenerational poverty cycles. Through the Coconut Farmers and Their Families Scholarship Program, the university directly supports agrarian dependents with comprehensive educational packages. In Academic Year 2024–2025, this program served 157 students in the first semester and expanded to 283 students in the second semester across the Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, and Salcedo campuses. The holistic package delivers a semester stipend, book allowance, first-year laptop grant, and thesis or internship allowance, directly aligning higher education outcomes with regional agricultural development. Furthermore, the university facilitates Tertiary Education Subsidies such as TES Listahanan, TDP-TES, SUC-TDP, and 4Ps-SWDI, delivering essential semester allowances to thousands of students belonging to low-income households.

Finally, regarding Multi-Sectoral Synergy and Funding Diversification, ESSU demonstrates innovative governance by pooling resources across diverse government agencies, private sectors, and local development programs to build a resilient financial support ecosystem. The university actively coordinates specialized grants with national entities including the Commission on Higher Education, Department of Science and Technology, Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources, Department of Agrarian Reform, Agricultural Competitiveness Enhancement Fund, and Overseas Workers Welfare Administration. These public investments

are further strengthened through private sector partnerships, such as the SMART and PLDT scholarship grant program, which complements government funding and enhances overall student retention. Through scalable systems management, diverse stakeholder networks, and an enduring commitment to rural inclusion, Eastern Samar State University proves that public higher education institutions can effectively eliminate economic barriers, foster student success, and contribute to regional transformation.

SCHOLARSHIP AND ASSISTANTSHIP PROGRAM – SY 2024-2025

TYPE AND NUMBER OF SCHOLARSHIP/GRANT			
Undergraduate	**1st Semester**	**2nd Semester**	**Amount of Grant per semester**
CHED Merit/STUFAP:			
CHED Full State Scholarship Program	**11**	**12**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan	*4*	*5*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
Guiuan	*4*	*4*	
Salcedo	*1*	*1*	
CHED Half State Scholarship Program	**17**	**16**	Php 20,000.00/semester
Borongan	*16*	*15*	
Guiuan			
Salcedo	*1*	*1*	
CHED Full State Scholarship Program (GAD)	**1**	**1**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan	*1*	*1*	
CHED Half State Scholarship Program (GAD)	**4**	**1**	Php 20,000.00/semester
Borongan	*4*	*1*	
Coconut Farmers And Their Families (COSCHO)	**157**	**283**	Php 35,000.00/semester stipend Php 5,000.00 book allowance/semester Php 30,000.00 laptop computer assistance during the 1st year Php 75,000.00 thesis/OJT (Internship) allowance
Borongan	*59*	*184*	
Can-avid	*21*	*21*	
Guiuan	*60*	*60*	
Salcedo	*17*	*18*	
SUC-TDP	**66**	**63**	Php 7,500.00/semester
Borongan	*66*	*48*	
Salcedo		*15*	
TDP-TES	**1,359**	**1,277**	Php 7,500.00/semester
Borongan	*319*	*248*	
Can-avid	*466*	*452*	
Guiuan	*396*	*432*	
Maydolong	*30*	*18*	
Salcedo	*148*	*127*	

TYPE AND NUMBER OF SCHOLARSHIP/GRANT			
Undergraduate	**1st Semester**	**2nd Semester**	**Amount of Grant per semester**
TES Listahanan	**2,144**	**1,979**	Php 10,000.00/semester
Borongan	*186*	*81*	
Can-avid	*111*	*109*	
Guiuan	*1,281*	*1,297*	
Maydolong	*215*	*141*	
Salcedo	*351*	*351*	
4Ps-SWDI	**754**	**722**	Php 10,000.00/semester
Borongan	*255*	*222*	
Guiuan	*482*	*482*	
Salcedo	*17*	*18*	
DOST-SEI	**12**	**12**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan	*12*	*12*	
BFAR	**15**	**15**	Php 5,000.00/month stipend Php 2,000.00 book allowance/per semester
Borongan	*15*	*15*	
DAR	**5**	**5**	Php 3,000.00/month stipend Php 2,000.00 book allowance/per semester
Borongan	*3*	*3*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
ACEF-GIAHEP	**1**	**5**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan		*3*	
Can-avid	*1*	*1*	
Salcedo		*1*	
OWWA	**15**	**14**	Php 10,000.00/semester
Borongan	*10*	*10*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
Guiuan	*2*	*2*	
Maydolong	*1*	*0*	
Private:			
SMART/PLDT	**14**	**18**	Php 17,500.00/semester
Borongan	*14*	*18*	
RA10931 (Free Tuition)	**23,427**	**22,206**	Amount billed to UniFAST
Borongan	*10,786*	*10,183*	
Can-avid	*3,335*	*3,138*	
Guiuan	*5,541*	*5,324*	
Maydolong	*1,384*	*1,327*	
Salcedo	*2,381*	*2,234*	
Total	**28,002**	**26,629**	

Link to Scholarship policies and RA10931:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1bVPBAcZ6gcegiNKH67AfHhWsWf8n8fzs/view?usp=drive_link
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Y9lly3INH3TbjaKkdUk0I6quLVQ9g67O/view?usp=drive_link

Employment Assistance to Students

Eastern Samar State University actively supports student retention, career readiness, and post-graduation transitions through its comprehensive employment assistance programs on the Borongan Campus. Throughout the year, these initiatives bridge the gap between academic

instruction and practical workplace experience by offering structured earning opportunities across different student demographics.

The program encompasses several distinct support channels tailored to the immediate financial and professional needs of enrollees. Specifically, the university engaged 7 regular student assistants who balance campus employment with their studies, alongside 35 participants enrolled in the Special Program for Employment of Students. To further assist individuals nearing or completing their higher education milestones, cash-for-work mechanisms provided vital financial relief to 26 graduating college students and 54 recent college graduates as they navigated their transition into the professional workforce.

Types of Employment Assistance	No. of Beneficiaries
Number of Student Assistants	**7**
Number of Students in the Special Program for Employment of Students (SPES)	**35**
Number of Cash for work beneficiaries – College Students (Graduating)	**26**
Number of Cash for work beneficiaries – College Graduates	**54**

SCHOLARSHIP AND FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE PROGRAM IMPLEMENTATION

The scholarship data reflects institutional excellence across several key innovation and impact indicators. In terms of social responsibility and regional impact, the administration of large-scale state and targeted grants—such as the Coconut Farmers and Their Families Scholarship Program supporting hundreds of agrarian families with stipends, book allowances, first-year laptop assistance, and thesis or OJT grants—demonstrates how the university directly targets marginalized and vital agricultural sectors to break generational poverty cycles. Furthermore, the document highlights successful synergistic networks uniting national government agencies like CHED, DOST, BFAR, DAR, and OWWA with private telecommunications partners such as SMART and PLDT, alongside institutional frameworks like Republic Act No. 10931. By facilitating the billing of over 22,000 to 23,000 students per semester directly through UniFAST, ESSU ensures that financial friction does not impede academic pursuits. Ultimately, reaching a total beneficiary footprint of over 28,000 student slots in the first semester and more than 26,000 in the second semester across decentralized regional campuses underscores scalable systems management, accountability, and inclusive access to higher education.

Tertiary Education Subsidy (TES) and Tulong Dunong Program (TDP)

On January 22–23, 2025, the Student Scholarship and Financial Assistance (SSFA) Office distributed financial assistance to **269 TES beneficiaries**, each receiving Php 10,000 (Total: Php

2,690,000) and **180 TDP beneficiaries**, each receiving Php 7,500 (Total: Php 1,350,000). These programs are funded by the Commission on Higher Education (CHED).

In April 2025, another **386 students** received Php 7,500 each under the TDP grant, totaling **Php 2.895 million**. Furthermore, on October 20, 2025, **1,299 students** across ESSU campuses received TDP stipends during a general assembly led by CHEDRO VIII Director Dr. Maximo C. Aljibe. These initiatives significantly strengthened students' ability to continue their education, reduced financial burdens on families, and reinforced ESSU's commitment to educational accessibility.











Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1EzQLZYEk6/

DOST Scholarship Campaign

On May 8, 2025, in collaboration with the Provincial Science and Technology Office (PSTO), the SSFA conducted an orientation on the DOST Junior Level Science Scholarship (JLSS) for third-year students in Engineering, Mathematics, and Science programs. This campaign promoted academic excellence in STEM fields and encouraged students to pursue research and innovation.



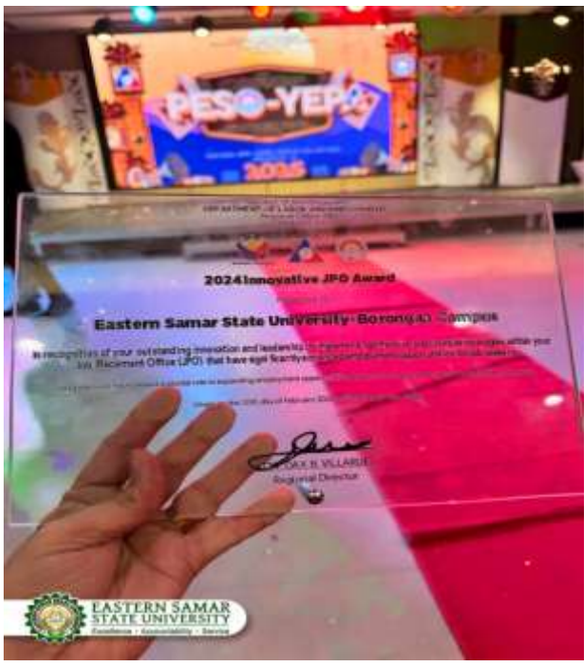




Link to posting
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19v1MZyqCc/

Regional PESO–YEPA Recognition

ESSU Main Campus earned distinction during the Regional Public Employment Service Office–Youth Employment Programs Award (PESO–YEPA) 2025 held in Palo, Leyte. The university received: 2024 Excellence PEIS User Award and 2024 Innovative JPO Award. These accolades highlighted ESSU's dedication to enhancing graduate employability and career support services.









Link to Posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1JE9cSmDXr/

SPES and LEGS Programs

The Special Program for the Employment of Students (SPES), conducted in partnership with DOLE Eastern Samar, qualified 30 student beneficiaries. Additionally, the Labor Education for Graduating Students (LEGS) seminar equipped graduating students with essential knowledge on workers' rights, labor laws, and employer responsibilities.









Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1ESPVpmJYu/
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1bPxrJ6hDx/

DSWD Cash-for-Work Program

In coordination with the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), SSAA facilitated assessment, interviews, and orientation for 283 beneficiaries under the Cash-for-Work Program. This initiative provided temporary employment opportunities for qualified students and graduates across ESSU campuses.







Link to posting:
https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19enLqnppF/

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.3.5 - Low or Lower-Middle Income Countries Student Support



1 NO POVERTY

1.3.5 - Low or Lower-Middle Income Countries Student Support

Eastern Samar State University's Scholarship and Financial Assistance Office, functioning under its core values of excellence, accountability, and service, administers a comprehensive system of institutional, private, and government grants across its main and external campuses. During the 2024–2025 academic year, these programs successfully extended crucial financial backing to thousands of undergraduate students.

Government and Commission on Higher Education programs formed a substantial pillar of this support. The CHED Merit and State Scholarship Programs provided full and half grants ranging from Php 20,000 to Php 40,000 per semester to academically qualified scholars. Sectoral and targeted initiatives—such as the Coconut Farmers and Their Families Scholarship Program—delivered extensive packages including a Php 35,000 semester stipend, book allowances, first-year laptop assistance, and thesis or OJT internship support. Additional federal backing was channeled through Tertiary Education Subsidies, SUC-TDP, TDP-TES, 4Ps-SWDI, and specialized agency grants from the Department of Science and Technology, the Bureau of Fisheries and Aquatic Resources, the Department of Agrarian Reform, the Agricultural Competitiveness Enhancement Fund, and the Overseas Workers Welfare Administration. Private partnerships also contributed, notably through the Smart and PLDT grant program which provided semester assistance to qualified recipients on the Borongan campus.

The vast majority of student financial relief is anchored by Republic Act No. 10931, the Universal Access to Quality Tertiary Education Act, signed into law on August 3, 2017. This landmark legislation mandates that qualified Filipino undergraduate students in state universities and colleges are exempt from paying tuition and other school fees, with institutional costs directly billed to the Unified Student Financial Assistance System for Tertiary Education. Across ESSU's network—spanning the Borongan, Can-avid, Guiuan, Maydolong, and Salcedo campuses—tens of thousands of enrollees benefited from free higher education provisions during the academic year

SCHOLARSHIP AND ASSISTANTSHIP PROGRAM – SY 2024-2025

TYPE AND NUMBER OF SCHOLARSHIP/GRANT			
Undergraduate	**1st Semester**	**2nd Semester**	**Amount of Grant per semester**
CHED Merit/STUFAP:			
CHED Full State Scholarship Program	**11**	**12**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan	*4*	*5*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
Guiuan	*4*	*4*	
Salcedo	*1*	*1*	
CHED Half State Scholarship Program	**17**	**16**	Php 20,000.00/semester
Borongan	*16*	*15*	
Guiuan			
Salcedo	*1*	*1*	
CHED Full State Scholarship Program (GAD)	**1**	**1**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan	*1*	*1*	
CHED Half State Scholarship Program (GAD)	**4**	**1**	Php 20,000.00/semester
Borongan	*4*	*1*	
Coconut Farmers And Their Families (COSCHO)	**157**	**283**	Php 35,000.00/semester stipend Php 5,000.00 book allowance/semester Php 30,000.00 laptop computer assistance during the 1st year Php 75,000.00 thesis/OJT (Internship) allowance
Borongan	*59*	*184*	
Can-avid	*21*	*21*	
Guiuan	*60*	*60*	
Salcedo	*17*	*18*	
SUC-TDP	**66**	**63**	Php 7,500.00/semester
Borongan	*66*	*48*	
Salcedo		*15*	
TDP-TES	**1,359**	**1,277**	Php 7,500.00/semester
Borongan	*319*	*248*	
Can-avid	*466*	*452*	
Guiuan	*396*	*432*	
Maydolong	*30*	*18*	
Salcedo	*148*	*127*	

TYPE AND NUMBER OF SCHOLARSHIP/GRANT			
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Maydolong	*215*	*141*	
Salcedo	*351*	*351*	
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Borongan	*12*	*12*	
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Borongan	*15*	*15*	
DAR	**5**	**5**	Php 3,000.00/month stipend Php 2,000.00 book allowance/per semester
Borongan	*3*	*3*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
ACEF-GIAHEP	**1**	**5**	Php 40,000.00/semester
Borongan		*3*	
Can-avid	*1*	*1*	
Salcedo		*1*	
OWWA	**15**	**14**	Php 10,000.00/semester
Borongan	*10*	*10*	
Can-avid	*2*	*2*	
Guiuan	*2*	*2*	
Maydolong	*1*	*0*	
Private:			
SMART/PLDT	**14**	**18**	Php 17,500.00/semester
Borongan	*14*	*18*	
RA10931 (Free Tuition)	**23,427**	**22,206**	Amount billed to UniFAST
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Maydolong	*1,384*	*1,327*	
Salcedo	*2,381*	*2,234*	
Total	**28,002**	**26,629**	

Link to Scholarship policies and RA10931:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1_LYK2ov0GG96WplVwtERbvNwOmc4AW-3/view?usp=drive_link

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JoZvGJNJF2BDmzACCFPGCvvZxC_blKVR/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.4.1. Local Start-up Assistance



1 NO POVERTY

1.4.1. Local Start-up Assistance

The university provides assistance in the local community supporting the start-up of financially and socially sustainable businesses through relevant education or resources.

Eastern Samar State University conducts structured community extension programs under initiatives like Poverty Alleviation through Business Integration Development Activities and specialized Livelihood Training Programs. These programs are designed to uplift local communities, such as Barangay Baras and Barangay San Juan on Tubabao Island in Guiuan, Eastern Samar, by imparting essential financial literacy, entrepreneurial competencies, and practical skills.

Among these initiatives, another activity featured a seminar workshop on understanding cash flow basics organized by the College of Business Management and Accountancy on May 10, 2025, at the Brgy. Baras Covered Court. Serving around 60 participants, primarily members of the Baras Women's Organization, local entrepreneurs, and students, the session demystified cash flow management for small businesses. It covered tracking cash inflows and outflows, understanding working capital, recognizing the dangers of selling purely on credit, utilizing digital or manual templates, and applying the direct method of cash flow statement preparation. Pre- and post-test evaluations indicated significant cognitive gains across participants, alongside high satisfaction ratings across training delivery and relevance metrics.

Similarly, an activity involved a seminar workshop on creating a simple business budget held on May 3, 2025, at the Brgy. Baras Covered Court. Drawing 50 participants from the Baras Women's Organization, local startup founders, and student facilitators, the program focused on enhancing foundational financial planning. Attendees learned how to distinguish between fixed and variable costs, establish revenue forecasts, monitor expenditures, set SMART financial goals, and create emergency and contingency funds. This session also demonstrated high engagement, active group participation, and measurable improvements in post-assessment financial literacy scores among local women micro-entrepreneurs.

Ultimately, these extension activities drive community empowerment and financial inclusion by bridging academic expertise from ESSU's business and education programs with grassroots community needs, helping women and local micro-entrepreneurs sustain small sari-sari stores and home-based enterprises. They also provide invaluable experiential learning for university students from programs such as Business Administration, Entrepreneurship, Accounting Information System, and Technical-Vocational Teacher Education, who act as facilitators, project documenters, and teaching assistants. Furthermore, every activity implements rigorous monitoring tools, including pre- and post-tests, client satisfaction feedback forms, and actionable post-activity reports to ensure continuous improvement for future extension cycles.

Programs/Activities		Link to the supporting documents
a.	SURVIVE – Empowering Communities Through Entrepreneurial Mindset and Behavior: Innovative Solutions for Social Development	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1CUtWIiobGDhXiIVACkSw83YCDgoB25GJ/view?usp=drive_link
b.	Entrepreneurial Skillset Training on Candle Making	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1fOKvPg38eVOTTdYMMQmg6GfqKXFEXtN6/view?usp=drive_link
c.	Livelihood Skills Training in Chicken Pastel Making	https://drive.google.com/file/d/181u9D_azWeYdGYOEXCDNEXgAUe3hh9ga/view?usp=drive_link
d.	PABIDA – A Seminar Workshop on Understanding Cash Flow Basics	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ZbYBHU_bDI5uvNQsFp7kjE-G7MA2vRT_/view?usp=drive_link
e.	PABIDA – A Seminar Workshop on Creating Simple Business Budget	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1h1X3koUa1dsUKnvVUehrCBSsqUA_rc7A/view?usp=drive_link
e.	FLEET – Seminar Workshop on Implementing Sustainable Practices and overcoming challenges for local small businesses.	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1DcegWB-MUNNmfaDw2Zx_uFCudBsvpjo_/view?usp=drive_link
f.	PABIDA –Setting Financial Goals for Business Success	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1zoxJaAishJf6n_t58II3EK-eU3gD0zAC/view?usp=drive_link
g.	POSITIVE – Skills Training on Basic Food and Beverage Service Operations	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1IIe6YM_0TJlHjKJePqH32RvEEzYpQA_W/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.4.2 - Local Start-up Financial Assistance



1 NO POVERTY

1.4.2 - Local Start-up Financial Assistance

The university provide financial assistance to the local community supporting the start-up of financially and socially sustainable businesses.

Turnover of Supplies and Equipment for Vinegar Production Project Benefiting 51 Farmers in Brgy. Casoroy

The Training and Extension Services Office (TESO) of Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) completed the turnover of supplies, materials, and equipment for the Vinegar Production Project on December 10, 2025. The beneficiary organizations from Barangay Casoroy, San Julian, Eastern Samar, collected the remaining supplies from the Supply and Property Management Office (SPMO) at the University's Main Campus, completing the delivery that began on October 30, 2024.

Funded by the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) through its Community Empowerment through Science and Technology (CEST) Program, the project aims to establish an **S&T Facility on Accelerated Vinegar Production for Economically Challenged Communities** in collaboration with ESSU. It directly benefits the Casoroy Multi-Cropping Farmers Association (CMCA) and the Brgy. Casoroy Farmers Association (CFA), with **51 members, 30 males and 21 females**.

The turnover was led by Dr. Lito D. Lacaba, Vice President for Research, Innovation and Extension; Dr. Ma. Natalia A. Ciasico, TESO Director; and Dr. Edmundo A. Campoto, ESSU Consultant and former University President. With all required supplies and equipment in place, the project can proceed to capacity-building, hands-on training, and accelerated vinegar production activities.

The initiative is expected to equip beneficiaries with practical production skills, promote the value-adding of locally available agricultural resources, and create opportunities for livelihood diversification and small-scale enterprise development. At the community level, it may stimulate local economic activity, encourage knowledge sharing, and support a more sustainable and self-reliant local economy. Through this partnership, DOST and ESSU continue to advance science and technology-based livelihood development and community empowerment.





ESSU Champions Local Farmers: Essential Materials and Coordination Meeting Held for Sustainable Goat Production Project in Borongan City

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its Training and Extension Services Office (TESO), conducted a turnover of essential construction materials and a coordination meeting on January 15, 2025, for the Goat Production Project under *"Infusion of S&T Intervention for Disadvantaged Communities in Borongan City in Support to PRLEC."* Funded by the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) through its Community Empowerment through Science and Technology (CEST) Program, the initiative aims to promote sustainable livestock production and improve livelihood opportunities among disadvantaged farming communities.

The project benefits two farmer organizations: the Balacdas Vegetable Farmers Association (BVPA), headed by Mr. Reynaldo Lapada, with **53 members**, and the Borongan Cacao Producers and Processors Association (BCPPA), headed by Mr. Godofredo Duzon, with **34 members**. Together, the organizations represent **87 farmer-members** who stand to benefit from improved goat production facilities, technical assistance, and livelihood development opportunities.

Leading the activity were Dr. Edmundo Campoto, former ESSU President and University Consultant; Dr. Lito D. Lacaba, Vice President for Research and Extension; Dr. Emilia L. Baquilod, former Vice President and University Consultant; and Dr. Natalia A. Ciasico, TESO Director, together with TESO staff and faculty members from the College of Agriculture.

The turnover and coordination meeting aimed to support facility development, clarify project responsibilities, and strengthen collaboration among the University and beneficiary organizations. The project is expected to enhance farmers' knowledge of livestock management, diversify household income sources, and strengthen collective enterprise development. For the wider community, sustainable goat production may stimulate local economic activity, encourage productive resource utilization, and serve as a model for science and technology-based livelihood initiatives. Through this collaboration, ESSU and DOST continue to promote agricultural innovation, community empowerment, and sustainable rural development in Borongan City, Eastern Samar.







Link to posting: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1BSkAxKP67/

TESO Hands Over Livestock to Local Beneficiary Groups

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU), through its Training and Extension Services Office (TESO), in partnership with the College of Agriculture (CAg), conducted goat turnover and management activities on January 22 and 24, 2025, for beneficiary organizations in Barangay Calicoan and Barangay Balacdas, Borongan City, Eastern Samar. The activities included livestock turnover, profiling, weighing, and vitamin administration to support proper animal care and monitoring.

The activity forms part of ESSU's sustainability initiatives under *"Infusion of S&T Intervention for Disadvantaged Communities in Borongan City,"* aligned with the Poverty Reduction, Livelihood, and Employment Cluster (PRLEC) and funded by the Department of Science and Technology (DOST) through its Community Empowerment through Science and Technology (CEST) Program.

The project benefits the Borongan Cacao Producers and Processors Association (BCPPA) in Barangay Calicoan, with **34 members**, and the Balacdas Vegetable Farmers Association (BVPA) in Barangay Balacdas, with **53 members**, for a total of **87 farmer-members**. Leading the ESSU team were Dr. Edmundo A. Campoto, former University President and Research and Extension Consultant; Dr. Lito D. Lacaba, Vice President for Research, Innovation, and Extension; TESO officials and staff; and faculty experts from the College of Agriculture.
The profiling and weighing of goats established baseline information for monitoring animal growth and productivity, while vitamin administration supported the animals' initial care. The initiative is expected to strengthen beneficiaries' skills in goat husbandry, improve livestock management, and provide additional livelihood and income-generating opportunities alongside their existing farming activities.

At the community level, sustainable goat production may stimulate local livestock trading, encourage the productive use of farm resources, and promote science-based agricultural

practices. Through continued technical assistance, proper animal health management, and active beneficiary participation, ESSU and DOST aim to help establish sustainable community-based livestock enterprises that contribute to livelihood diversification and rural economic development in Borongan City, Eastern Samar.

Link to posting: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/19DEJu7fsv/



In addition to the above-mentioned programs and projects, the University implements various initiatives that provide financial and livelihood assistance to the local community, particularly aspiring and existing entrepreneurs. These initiatives aim to support the establishment and development of start-up businesses, promote livelihood opportunities and income generation, and strengthen the capacity of beneficiaries to establish financially viable and socially sustainable enterprises. Through these efforts, the University contributes to inclusive economic growth and sustainable community development.

Programs/Activities		**Link to the supporting documents**
a.	FARMERS-PRAMIS – Fostering Agricultural Resilience through Management of Research and Extension Services-Promotion of Rural Agricultural Modernization and Innovation Towards Sustainability	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1bq18bmDW-B7S-6GW4G0IzbkzsfQRvS10/view?usp=drive_link
b.	PAHID – A Training Workshop on Mixed Media Textile Art Printing	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1S-yPB2U8dM7GkKBitKy6C2TY9mukE_vU/view?usp=drive_link
c.	WHOLE HARVESTED – Needs assessment and Consultative Meeting with Maydolong astern Tuna Processing Association	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1WRn-vCTffeT_1GpdPmtEkpKRLRj6GUJH/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.4.3 - Programs for Services Access



1 NO POVERTY

1.4.3 - Programs for Services Access

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) implements dedicated training programs and community initiatives to improve access to basic services, specifically focusing on energy security, sustainability, and renewable energy adoption. Through the College of Engineering's Electrical Engineering Program, the university conducts the **EE CARES (Energy Efficiency: Constellation, Assessment and Renewable Energy Solutions)** initiative. This extension program translates institutional research—such as assessments of solar energy in Eastern Samar and wave-to-electricity conversion prototypes—into practical community applications.

The program provides capacity-building workshops, technical training for local electricians, and educational resources targeting schools, local government units (LGUs), non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and small-medium enterprises. A key component of this initiative includes the **Dissemination Caravan on Research Output of Solar Energy**, exemplified by community training conducted in Barangay San Gabriel, Borongan City. During these caravans, faculty experts educate local residents on the economic and environmental benefits of solar power, safe installation practices, energy auditing, and battery storage solutions to address regional challenges related to unstable power supply and high electricity costs. By combining technical training, community outreach, and pilot renewable energy installations, ESSU actively empowers local communities to secure reliable, sustainable, and cost-effective energy access.

Link to document:
https://drive.google.com/file/d/1Ufhxl_KAAs2q35oc1KFNFTJZbjMytAtr/view?usp=drive_link

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SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT GOALS

SDG 1 NO POVERTY

1.4.4 - Policy Addressing Poverty



1 NO POVERTY

1.4.4 - Policy Addressing Poverty

Eastern Samar State University (ESSU) actively participates in multi-level policy-making and collaborative governance to implement sustainable programs and policies aimed at eradicating poverty in all its dimensions. At the local level, the university has pursued governance integration through initiatives such as the partnership and consultation meeting to establish the ESSU-DILG Governance Center, creating institutional mechanisms to support grassroots capacity-building, local planning, and community development.



Link: https://www.facebook.com/share/p/1BjDjvzzP9/

At the regional level, ESSU has reinforced its strategic collaboration with national social welfare agencies, highlighted by the formal renewal of partnership with the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD) for the effective implementation and monitoring of the Pantawid Pamilyang Pilipino Program (4Ps). Through these collaborative frameworks across local administrative bodies and regional welfare networks, the university embeds empirical research, stakeholder engagement, and community outreach directly into policy formulation and poverty alleviation programs.



Link: https://www.facebook.comshare/p/19rheGmuiA/